always been an exacting one. That current generations have direct memories of multiple conflicts also shapes our thinking.

Each of these aspects naturally requires an upgraded response. But there are significant concerns as well that are embedded in our increasingly connected existence. Because they are intrinsic to the engagement with the world, there is no getting away from these problems. When it comes to security, doing more and doing better is no longer enough. India needs to do things differently and that means thinking differently. Enhancing security today requires re-imagining it.

Those who spend their lives dealing with national security perhaps appreciate more readily how much our very definition of that term has evolved. Change is driven by the impact of globalization on all societies, the penetration of technology into our daily lives and a more competitive global scenario. What, where, when and how threats emanate is as complicated to anticipate as the manner in which we need to respond, protect and counter. We are required to not only deal with a more intricate framework in which threats are assessed but do so with greater variables. Together, they ensure that the normal has become increasingly unpredictable and that the uneventful is but an exception.

At the heart of the security conundrum is the seamlessness created by the fusion of economic interdependence and technological interpenetration. They have facilitated the flow of information, ideas and ideologies in a manner previously inconceivable. There are the human aspects as well, pertaining to the extent of observance of rules and norms. We cannot be oblivious of the paradox that while our existence is more capability-driven, we are more vulnerable at the same time. The very factors that hold so much promise for growth and prosperity are also the source of anxiety in the wrong hands.

Understanding why security issues need to be approached beyond the orthodox construct springs from these particular realizations. India is a polity that not only values its engagement with the world but is actively seeking to expand it. In fact, the drivers of progress at home link us more deeply every day to a range of factors outside. The task before us is, therefore, to arrive at optimal solutions that maximize benefits while minimizing risks. The era when this could be done through physical controls is now well behind us. Instead, the requirement is to comprehend, anticipate, prepare and out-think whatever problems the nation is likely to